



His neighbour is a victim of the new reality shows on TV

Surveillance cameras to counter terrorism, new social networking sites and the personalised service from Google Earth means that people know exactly where you are 24/7



Bharat's chair monitors vital signs and tells him when to de-stress

Technology is also starting to dominate fashion, with the introduction of the M-dress, a garment that doubles as a mobile phone. Produced by CuteCircuit, the M-Dress comes with a slot for a standard SIM card. When the dress rings, you merely raise your hand to your head to answer the call. This futuristic fusion of fashion and technology is becoming more common as clothes designers are increasingly incorporating electronics into their garments. Technology, however, is also starting to become Orwellian. Thanks to Facebook, Twitter and the new personalised service from Google Earth, everyone knows where you are every minute of the day. With hundreds of surveillance cameras introduced to combat terrorism, it really is Big Brother time in 2020. Cameras also dominate another area of concern, television and the increasingly candid reality shows. With hus-

bands, wives, lovers, mothers and fathers spilling out their darkest secrets in public, divorce and marital violence are on the rise, sparking a huge backlash, almost as big as the one against technology's dominance of almost all aspects of everyone's life.

The movement against reality tv is gathering steam as is the one against technology. The former is being backed by the BJP's new joint leadership of Arun Jaitley and Sushma Swaraj while the movement against technology is being spearheaded by the two Yadavs, Lalu Prasad and Mulayam Singh. Both are demanding a return to tradition, family values and greater individual privacy. Already, it has led to massive, violent street protests. In 2020, India is at war with itself. It almost appears that not much had changed since 1947.

The use of technology in genetics is another area of progress and concern. It allowed scientists to find a cure for cancer and HIV but also lets people choose to have designer babies, dictating their choice of the colour of skin, hair and eyes, which has led to a violent debate on medical ethics and morality. Indeed, it is immortality that is literally dominating lives, thanks to companies like E-Uphoria. The wellness industry—health-related products, gyms, anti-ageing potions, health foods etc—is the single biggest after the oil sector and people like Bharat are the new corporate icons. His company has made a fortune with its latest product: feel-good endorphins produced in a lab and sold in a bottle. In fact, in a world of uncertainty, stress, conflict and tension, happiness mainly comes in bottles. ■

In a Grave New World of economic uncertainty, stress and conflict, wellness and happiness largely comes in the form of poly-pills or in a bottle



The use of technology is omnipotent but also increasingly dangerous